Hunter Woodall

LEAD SOFTWARE ENGINEER | GENERATIVE AI & SEARCH

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TECHNICAL SKILLS

Frontend & Mobile: React & Next.js · Angular · Svelte & SvelteKit · TypeScript · Tailwind · React Native
Backend/Data/Infrastructure: Go · Node.js · Python · Rust · AWS · Terraform · GraphQL · CI/CD Pipelines
AI: LLM agents & RAG · MCP · Custom Skills and Workflows
Testing & Quality: Playwright · Vitest ·Type checking · Drizzle schemas · verification pipelines
Hardware: Custom PCs · Self-hosting
Focus: Engineering leadership · Generative AI · LLM optimization · ETL Pipelines · Caching · Security

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Lead Software Engineer | Zoovu (acquired XGen AI) **| Remote -** *April 2026 - present*

Director of Product Engineering | XGen AI | Remote - *October 2025 - April 2026*

- Manage and mentor 10 engineers from senior to junior level.
- Reduced LLM spending by 24% in 2026; integrate advanced models to further reduce inference costs and latency.
- Leading engineering for Enterprise AI search and retrieval platform serving millions of requests/day for Fortune 500 brands.
- Serve as the primary technical solution designer, translating feature requests and customer needs into scalable architectures and implementation plans.
- Own the multi-tenant ETL pipeline ingesting and normalizing customer data from many source formats.
- Improve search speed and reliability through caching layers, and ensure engineering work follows security guidelines and development best practices.
- Lead customer implementations and onboarding; partner with Product, Design, and Operations to prioritize improvements informed by customer feedback.

Lead Software Engineer | XGen AI | Remote - *April 2022 - October 2025*

- Developed a customer-facing platform and back-end APIs using GraphQL, Go, and Python.
- Custom high-throughput filtering and faceting engine behind search and recommendation APIs (millions of requests/day).
- Led team shipping AI Software to Enterprise customers including Gucci, Sonos, and Coach.
- Automated manual tasks across teams to improve operational efficiency and workflows.
- MCP server giving staff natural-language admin control, with role-scoped read-only access for customers.
- Created a Natural-language-to-query agent that turns plain-English requests into deterministic, auditable filters over each customer's data.

Senior Software Engineer | Denso Manufacturing | Maryville - *August 2021 - April 2022*

- Developed scalable front-end and back-end architectures using JavaScript and C#; administered databases for large-scale production applications.
- Worked on an in-house live manufacturing dashboard to gather metrics on machines and line operations.
- Automated an inventory workflow that saves 150 man hours a year.
- Collaborated across teams to improve application functionality, performance, and user experience.

Process Engineer | Denso Manufacturing | Maryville - *August 2019 - August 2021*

- Troubleshooting equipment failures, optimized production processes, and designed jigs and industrial equipment using CAD and other 3D modeling tools.
- Helped build a web application to automate production documentation and streamline workflows.
- Designed standoffs that cut scrap production by 20%.

Teaching Assistant | University of Tennessee | Knoxville - *January 2019 - August 2019*

- Taught engineering instrumentation lab procedures, evaluated technical reports, and supported experiments and data analysis using MATLAB.

Medical Device Intern | University of Tennessee | Knoxville - May 2017 - August 2017

- Researched and presented medical device senior design project ideas; developed one into a complete concept informed by shadowing medical professionals.

EDUCATION

Graduate work in Mechanical Engineering | University of Tennessee, Knoxville - January 2019 - August 2019

- GPA: 4.0; 15 credit hours remaining toward the master's degree (not completed).

Bachelor's Degree | University of Tennessee, Knoxville - August 2013 - May 2018

- Graduated with highest honors and the highest GPA in the graduating class; overall GPA: 3.85; departmental GPA: 3.9. Minor in Material Science.